



STATUS REPORT

Zambia: status report

Edition of 2026-08-11 · 145 systems and instruments tracked, 54 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-11 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/ZMB/ledger.csv](#) (145 systems and instruments, 54 of them Not held). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Zambia's digital state collects revenue well and identifies people slowly. Over 400 government services are onboarded across the service bus, payment gateway, national portal and payment platform, with more than K8.8 billion collected cumulatively ([Accountant General's office](#)). Against that, biometric enrolment on the national register stood at about 1.3 million people at the end of 2025, and issuance of the biometric registration card was deferred until after the general election of 13 August 2026 ([ministry account](#)).

The governing instruments moved in one direction only. Enforcement of the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 was declared fully operational on 18 July 2026, twenty-six days before that election ([enforcement account](#)). The Office of the Data Protection Commissioner has been operational since early 2025 and the base contains no registration count, enforcement decision, fine or breach notification for it at any date.

Only 33.0% of Zambians used the internet in October 2025, unchanged across two annual readings ([compiler analysis](#)), against government coverage claims of 80% to 94% that state no basis.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Border-post connectivity upgrade across five trade corridors	PLANNED ↗	National standard set out and an independent ICT audit commissioned

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Chanida-Cassacatiza cross-border fibre interconnector	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Commissioned 2026-02-23
Communication Towers Project Phase 2	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Disbursement at 87.8% as reported by the Ministry of Finance, July 2022
Direct-to-cell satellite trials	PILOTING ↗	Zambia named as a trial site
Government Wide Area Network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Phase 1 declared complete 2026-03-24; border-post gaps confirmed 2026-08-05
GovLink Private 4G	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at Ndola Teaching Hospital
Independent tower portfolio	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Development-finance equity exited 2021-03-31; a US\$75m loan fully disbursed from 2021
National ICT Development Project Phase II, backbone extension	PLANNED, FINANCING UNDRAWN ↗	Disbursement at 0% as of July 2022
Quality-of-service enforcement regime	PLANNED ↗	Quarterly network-performance reporting announced
Starlink service in Zambia	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Market entry October 2023; among the top three African markets by June 2026
Umoja cable terrestrial segment through Zambia	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Ready for service stated as 2027
4G and mobile broadband population coverage	NOT HELD	—
Fixed and mobile broadband pricing	NOT HELD	—
Satellite operator licence terms in Zambia	NOT HELD	—

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Memorandum of understanding on a national AI data centre	PLANNED ↗	Signed at the 2026 Zambia Mobile Congress
Zambia National Data Centre and backup facilities	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Phase 1 implementation commenced January 2016
Commercial and colocation data-centre capacity	NOT HELD	—
Government cloud and data-hosting arrangements	NOT HELD	—

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Solar power at local authority offices	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Stated complete for all 116 councils at a state ICT institute briefing
Electricity supply to data centres	NOT HELD	—
Power supply and backup at telecommunications sites	NOT HELD	—

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
International transit and wholesale bandwidth pricing	NOT HELD	—
National internet exchange point	NOT HELD	—

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
CCTV (Public Protection) Bill and National Public Security Command Centre	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	On the record in civil-society monitoring current to late December 2025
Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025	IMPLEMENTED, CONTESTED ↗	Enforcement declared fully operational
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed by the President 8 April 2025
Law Association challenge to the 2025 cyber Acts	PLANNED ↗	Association reported as set to mount a challenge
Lusaka safe-city surveillance system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Lusaka listed among Chinese-supplied deployments in an eleven-country mapping
Zambia Cyber Security Agency	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Named by the home affairs ministry as strengthening the response to online scams
Central Monitoring Centre	NOT HELD	—
National Computer Incident Response Team	NOT HELD	—
National cybersecurity policy or strategy	NOT HELD	—

Zambia's network figures do not reconcile, and the disagreement is between the state and its own financier. The World Bank appraisal of January 2025 records 10,000 km of fibre ([appraisal document](#)); the Minister of Technology and Science stated in May 2026 that the network had grown from 15,000 km in 2021 to more than 45,000 km, with national coverage at 94% ([ministerial statement](#)). Neither states its counting basis, and the two accounts have not been reconciled.

The same ambiguity attaches to the word connected. In February 2025 the state ICT institute's own provincial officer said site works were complete at twelve Western Province sites but that completion depended on last-mile connections still outstanding; by March 2026 all 116 councils were reported connected and phase one complete ([briefing](#)). In August 2026 the institute confirmed that four named border posts still have connectivity gaps, with no budget or completion date published ([status update](#)).

Two builds are real. A government-owned private 4G network for public institutions was launched at Ndola Teaching Hospital on 15 July 2026, with the national electronic health record migrating onto it ([launch account](#)), and a cross-border fibre interconnector to Mozambique was commissioned on 23 February 2026.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Government Service Bus	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Eight local authorities onboarded from June 2026
IDEA Programme regional coordination	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Third project steering committee convened in Lusaka
ZamConnect data-exchange layer	PLANNED ↗	Named in the acceleration project appraisal as a complementary platform for data integration and exchange
ZamConnect in operation	NOT HELD	—

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Biometric National Registration Card issuance	PLANNED ↗	Deferred to after the 2026-08-13 general election
Integrated National Registration Information System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	End-to-end automation of birth and death notification reported under way
MOSIP-based national digital ID system	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Procurement of an international system integrator opened
National Registration Card, paper	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In issue since before independence in 1964
Nationwide mobile registration campaign for 3.5m ID documents	DISCONTINUED ↗	Launched at Kitwe for a three-month run
Outcome of the April 2025 mobile campaign for 3.5 million ID documents	NOT HELD	—
Refugee biometric registration card issuance	NOT HELD	—
System integrator contract award for the digital ID	NOT HELD	—

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cheque clearing	DISCONTINUED, PHASE-OUT UNDER WAY ↗	Acceptance to stop from June 2026
National Financial Switch	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cost-reduction objective stated on record as not yet delivered
ZamPay and the Government Electronic Payment Gateway	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cumulative collections put at over K8.8 billion
Central bank national payment system statistics	NOT HELD	—

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Civil registration of births and deaths	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Three-pillar strategy stated at the 8th Africa civil registration day
National Carbon Registry	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-08-08
National Spatial Data Infrastructure Policy and Portal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Policy and portal launched in Lusaka
Zambia Integrated Land Administration System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Went live 2023-05-17 after data migration from the predecessor system
Company and business register	NOT HELD	—
Land parcels or titles held in the land administration system	NOT HELD	—

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Constituency Development Fund management information system	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Data entry under way across councils, full operationalisation stated for June 2026
SmartCare 2.0 Hospital Edition	PILOTING ↗	Pilot launched at Ndola Teaching Hospital
SmartCare Pro national electronic health record	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Deployment reported at about 80% of health facilities
Education management information system	NOT HELD	—

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cabinet directive on open-source technology	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Directive issued to ministries alongside the spatial data infrastructure launch
Contract Tracking and Management Information System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched with the Ministry of Justice
Digital loan system for civil servants	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Briefed to the microfinance association 2026-08-05
Electronic Government (Amendment) Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Presented at a state ICT institute stakeholder meeting
Online Passport Application and Payment System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched, with over 1,000 passports processed online at launch
Property Management Information System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by the infrastructure ministry with the state ICT institute
SMART Office Management System	PILOTING ↗	Demonstrated at health ministry headquarters, Luapula selected as pilot province
ZamPortal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Over 400 services onboarded across the payment and service ecosystem

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Satellite terminals in rural public facilities	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Kits installed in Moomba Chiefdom, Kazungula district

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
e-Council platform	IMPLEMENTED, EIGHT OF 116 COUNCILS ↗	Eight local authorities onboarded from June 2026
Local authorities on the national portal	IMPLEMENTED, ONE OF 116 CONFIRMED ↗	Lusaka City Council went live as the first of 116 local authorities
Whether the seven pilot councils went live on the national portal by 2026-06-30	NOT HELD	—

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Regulator annual or quarterly market performance report after 2022	NOT HELD	—
Statistics agency release programme	NOT HELD	—

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Satellite and AI farm traceability platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Founder account of the platform in use; company founded 2022
A national earth-observation or satellite-data programme	NOT HELD	—

Over 400 services are onboarded and more than K8.8 billion collected cumulatively across the government's payment and service platforms ([Accountant General's office](#)); eight of 116 local authorities went live in June 2026 and returned about K21.7 million in their first month ([collection figures](#)).

Three enrolment figures on the base do not reconcile — 1.5 million in September 2024, about 1.3 million in December 2025, and about 1.5 million of about 20 million in July 2026 — with no revision reported by any party ([ministry account](#)). The paper registration card, covering some 94% of adults in 2021, remains the operative credential, and card issuance was deferred until after the August 2026 election against a funded target of 4 million by October 2030 ([appraisal document](#)).

Birth registration stood at 14% in 2024, with 6% of children holding a certificate, against a target of 50% by end-2026 with no measured mid-point.

The exchange layer named at appraisal has not appeared, and no source reports it in operation ([appraisal document](#)). Exchange runs through the government service bus instead, and the national electronic health record is deployed in approximately 80% of health facilities ([institute account](#)).

A [National Carbon Registry](#) was launched on 8 August 2026 as the compulsory route for carbon-credit transactions, administered by the Zambia Environmental Management Agency and reporting into the National Integrated MRV System and the UNFCCC Centralised Accounting and Reporting Platform; no operating rules or access terms are published.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, statutory text	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Gazetted text acquired 2026-08-09; commenced 12 May 2025 by Statutory Instrument 22 of 2025
ICT (Universal Access) Regulations, 2012	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Gazetted 15 June 2012
Mobile money levy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Rate doubled during 2025
Postal and Courier Services Bill 2026	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Public written submissions closed 2026-07-27
Startup Bill	PLANNED ↗	Named by a Ministry of Technology and Science representative
Access to information law	NOT HELD	—
Enforcement outturn under the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025	NOT HELD	—

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Civil registration modernisation programme	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Africa civil registration day launched on three stated pillars
COMESA Regional AI Strategy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Sensitisation workshop launched in Lusaka
National AI Strategy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Technology ministry permanent secretary says the strategy is nearing the end of its implementation cycle and will be reviewed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National AI Strategy text	NOT HELD	—

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Kwacha onboarding to the regional real-time gross settlement system	PLANNED ↗	Attributed to a regional central bank spokesperson
Zambian Secretary-General of the African Telecommunications Union	PLANNED, TERM BEGINS 2027-01-01 ↗	Elected on the fourth round with 21 of 34 votes, Abuja
Ratification of the AU Malabo Convention	NOT HELD	—

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Ministry of Health ICT Standards and Guidelines	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Issued January 2014
National data-sharing, interoperability or data-classification standard	NOT HELD	—

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Data Protection Act 2021	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Named as part of the operative framework in the enforcement statement
Office of the Data Protection Commissioner	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Asked by nine civil society organisations to examine a beneficiary contact list, 2026-07-31
Transfer of the refugee registration database to the home affairs ministry	PLANNED ↗	Grant effective 2024-12-23; provided for as a project subcomponent
Cabinet decision to repeal and replace the Data Protection Act 2021	NOT HELD	—
Data Protection Act statutory instruments and regulations	NOT HELD	—
Data protection regulator enforcement record	NOT HELD	—

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Public consultation on the Postal Services Act review	DISCONTINUED ↗	Submissions closed one working day after the consultations ended
ZICTA consent judgment on internet access interruption	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Entered after the August 2021 election-period blocking; reason for any interruption due within 36 hours
Parliamentary and public contestation of Zambia's data governance	NOT HELD	—

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
EU-Zambia digital cooperation	NOT HELD	—
Legal basis for personal-data transfers between Zambia and the EU	NOT HELD	—

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
2026 Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Adopted at the continental telecommunications plenipotentiary conference
National open data portal and open data policy	NOT HELD	—

Both 2025 cyber statutes are now held as gazetted and both are court-gated. The Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 makes its investigatory powers subject to a court order, and the companion Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, acquired on 2026-08-09, requires a law enforcement officer to apply ex parte to a judge of the High Court for an interception of communication order under section 29, valid three months and renewable once; interception without a prior order is confined by section 30 to preventing bodily harm, loss of life or damage to property, and the officer must place the written confirmation, an affidavit, the recording and a transcript before a judge within two days. The blanket interception mandate a United States embassy alert attributes to the regime is not a provision of either Act. Section 3(1) does establish the Zambia Cyber Security Agency in the Office of the President, under the President's general direction, and “law enforcement officer” extends to any person the President designates by statutory instrument.

Enforcement of the Cyber Crimes Act was declared fully operational on 18 July 2026, twenty-six days before the general election of 13 August, with compliance obligations extended to financial institutions, telecommunications operators, digital platforms, mobile money providers and e-commerce businesses ([enforcement account](#)). No prosecution, charge or conviction count is published. The Law Association was reported in April 2025 as set to mount a legal challenge; no filing, hearing or ruling appears anywhere in the base in the sixteen months since.

The Office of the Data Protection Commissioner became operational with a controller registration deadline of 30 April 2025, and the base holds no registration count, enforcement decision, fine, breach notification or annual report for it at any date. On 31 July 2026 nine civil society organisations asked the Office to examine the source of the contact list behind SMS messages sent to Social Cash Transfer beneficiaries before the 13 August election ([civil society statement](#)); no response is on the record. Monitoring current to late 2025 records Cabinet planning to repeal the 2021 Data Protection Act; nothing has followed.

Research mapping records mass surveillance in Zambia despite no terrorism threat and documents it repurposed against political opposition, while no authorising instrument, oversight body, camera count or retention rule is held ([research mapping](#)).

A consent judgment entered after the August 2021 platform blocking binds the regulator not to interrupt access outside its authority and to state the reason for any interruption within 36 hours; the technology ministry has committed not to shut down the internet at the August 2026 election ([coalition letter](#)).

Zambia's universal-access levy has a statutory basis on file for the first time. Statutory Instrument No. 38 of 2012 caps a licensee's contribution to the Universal Access and Service Fund at not exceeding 1.5% of gross annual turnover, itself capped at 50% of total collectable annual operating fees payable to the regulator, payable annually in advance ([gazetted instrument](#)). No later rate, amendment or the Fund's own balance and disbursement record is held.

A third account of the national AI strategy's stage does not reconcile with the other two. The Ministry of Technology and Science permanent secretary said on 7 August 2026 that the current strategy is nearing the end of its implementation cycle and will be reviewed, naming limited computing infrastructure, data quality and the absence of interoperable standards as adoption barriers ([seminar account](#)). That statement sits against the Presidential Delivery Unit's account a month earlier that the strategy was nearing completion, and against a continental review that already treats a Zambian strategy as an existing text; the base cannot settle which is current.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cyber security agency artificial-intelligence remit	IMPLEMENTED ↗	AI-enabled trafficking and online scams placed inside the agency's response
Feature-phone AI voice service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cited as a deployed feature-phone AI voice service
ITU AI for Good Lab	PLANNED ↗	Disclosed as an opportunity; no agreement signed
National Assembly artificial-intelligence automation	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Implementing partner's first-hand account published
Artificial intelligence budget line or implementation costing	NOT HELD	—
National artificial intelligence compute inventory	NOT HELD	—
National artificial intelligence institution or agency	NOT HELD	—

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Dot Com Zambia PLC	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Listing on the Lusaka Securities Exchange described as recent
ICT sector contribution to GDP	NOT HELD	—

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
E-MARK Innovation Hub	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Ran the nine-month pipeline that took Team Zambia to the Geneva global finals
Green Giraffe	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Founded 2022; founder interview on the record
Padue	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Founded 2025; profiled 2026-07-21
Government innovation or venture fund	NOT HELD	—
Technology hub inventory	NOT HELD	—
Zambian startup funding totals	NOT HELD	—

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
United States health financing memorandum of understanding	PLANNED, NOT PROCEEDING ↗	Reported shelved in May 2026 over data terms and a minerals precondition

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Zambia-China digital cooperation talks	PLANNED ↗	Seminar on China-Zambia Artificial Intelligence Cooperation reported; no agreement signed

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Edge data centre plan	PLANNED ↗	Named among target countries for future edge data centres

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Any Gulf-state technology engagement with Zambia	NOT HELD	—

The head of the Presidential Delivery Unit said on 17 July 2026 that the national AI strategy was nearing completion and invited stakeholder contributions ([statement](#)), while a continental review published on 1 July 2026 reads Zambia's national AI strategy alongside six others as an existing text. No draft, publication date, budget or institutional architecture is held.

No domestic artificial intelligence institution exists; the only one on offer is an international laboratory disclosed as an opportunity in July 2026, with no signature, funding, siting or timetable. The home affairs permanent secretary said in July 2026 that the cyber security agency's establishment had strengthened the response to online scams and AI-enabled trafficking.

A memorandum signed in June 2026 covers AI infrastructure, sovereign cloud hosting, digital public infrastructure for 25 ministries and a co-invested national data centre, with no value, site, capacity or timetable disclosed ([signing account](#)). It precedes the strategy that would govern it, and the same vendor built the existing national data centre.

The United States health financing memorandum is not proceeding. The Foreign Minister said in May 2026 that it had stalled over data terms the government considers unacceptable, and it was reported shelved that month after Washington sought signature alongside a critical-minerals pact ([news agency report](#)).

29% of sampled Zambian startups have at least one female co-founder, the highest in the sample.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Gender gap in internet use or mobile ownership	NOT HELD	—
Rural-urban internet use split	NOT HELD	—

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Universal Access and Service Fund	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Board assessment tour of Muchinga, Northern and Luapula projects
Device affordability and data cost as a share of income	NOT HELD	—
Digital access for persons with disabilities	NOT HELD	—

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital Transformation Centres Initiative	IMPLEMENTED ↗	ICT equipment handed to Mpika Youth Resource Centre
National digital literacy rate or programme	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital skills and capabilities component	PLANNED ↗	Board approval of the parent grant
Vendor global academy training commitment	PLANNED ↗	Included in the memorandum signed at the Zambia Mobile Congress
Digital skills targets under the e-Government Plan 2023-2026	NOT HELD	—

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Revenue authority research memorandum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Memorandum and non-disclosure agreement signed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
University or national ICT research institute	NOT HELD	—

Zambia has one domestic digital budget line in the entire wiki. ZMW 255,000,000 was approved for fiscal year 2026 to upgrade digital infrastructure and quality of service, particularly rural; the record is built from press reporting rather than an appropriation document, the stage is unclear, and no funding source is named ([approval account](#)). There is no domestic budget archive for Zambia, where nineteen other countries have one, so no appropriation figure in this report rests on a budget document.

The universal access fund operates without published accounts: no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count is held for any year.

Financial inclusion reached 80.1% of adults in 2025 from 69.4% in 2020, with mobile money use at 76.2% ([survey figures](#)). Internet use did not follow: 33.0% in October 2025, unchanged year on year while user numbers grew with the population ([compiler analysis](#)). The wiki holds no rural-urban or gender disaggregation of internet use to explain the gap.

External financing carries the programme: a US\$100 million grant board-approved on 11 September 2025, of which US\$5 million is for digital skills ([appraisal document](#)). Against that, the training the base can evidence is 146 public officers in three districts of one province.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital Zambia Acceleration Project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Board approval 2025-09-11
Improved Rural Connectivity Project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Stated closing date of 2025-12-31
Lupiya digital lending	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Tenth anniversary announcement
Zambia Refugee and Host Communities Project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Became effective 2024-12-23

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital identity memorandum with Ethiopia	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported signed; signing date not established
Government compact with the Payments Association of Zambia	IMPLEMENTED ↗	State House meeting 2026-02-26
UNDP and Tony Blair Institute memorandum of understanding	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed in Lusaka 2025-11-20
Zoyk and Visa partnership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-06-03

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Ministry of Technology and Science annual appropriation	NOT HELD	—
State ICT institute appropriation and project counterpart funding	NOT HELD	—
Universal Access and Service Fund accounts	NOT HELD	—

(narrative not yet written)

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Computer Incident Response Team	The full Project Appraisal Document's component text, which would state whether a national response team is funded, hosted or operating; the wiki holds only the datasheet and strategic context paragraphs	not yet probed
Central Monitoring Centre	The text of the Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025 and any commencement or establishment order; the base carries the Centre only as an embassy and civil-society characterisation, with no evidence it has been built, sited, staffed or funded	not yet probed
National cybersecurity policy or strategy	A published national cybersecurity strategy or the critical-information-infrastructure designation list required under the 2025 Act	not yet probed
Commercial and colocation data-centre capacity	A regulator or operator disclosure of installed and delivered IT load in MW, or rack count, by facility; the base holds no Zambian data-centre capacity figure of any kind after the 2015 build description	not yet probed
Government cloud and data-hosting arrangements	The state ICT institute's hosting policy or a government cloud contract stating where ministry data and the portal and service-bus workloads physically reside	not yet probed
National internet exchange point	A regulator or exchange-operator statement of peering members and traffic exchanged; the base holds no reference to a Zambian exchange point at all	not yet probed
International transit and wholesale bandwidth pricing	The regulator's annual market performance report for a year after 2022, or an operator's published wholesale tariff; the last market report the wiki holds is for 2022	not yet probed
Power supply and backup at telecommunications sites	An operator or regulator statement of site electrification, generator and battery coverage, or reported outage hours attributable to grid failure	not yet probed
Electricity supply to data centres	A utility or facility-operator statement of contracted load and backup arrangements for the national data centre and any commercial facility	not yet probed
Satellite operator licence terms in Zambia	The regulator's licence award notice or fee schedule for satellite service providers; the held market report gives a continental fee range but no Zambian figure	not yet probed
4G and mobile broadband population coverage	A regulator coverage report by technology; the government's 92% and 94% coverage claims state no unit or measurement basis	not yet probed
Fixed and mobile broadband pricing	A price basket after the 2025 appraisal's statement that 5 GB of fixed broadband costs more than 12% of gross national income per head; no post-2025 Zambian tariff figure is held	not yet probed
System integrator contract award for the digital ID	The procurement award notice naming the integrator, contract value and delivery dates; the base holds the March 2026 procurement opening and nothing after it	not yet probed
Outcome of the April 2025 mobile campaign for 3.5 million ID documents	A registration department or home affairs ministry closing report for the three-month campaign, giving registration cards and birth certificates actually issued	not yet probed
Refugee biometric registration card issuance	The refugee and host communities project implementation status report, which would show disbursement and whether biometric registration under the identity subcomponent has begun	not yet probed
Land parcels or titles held in the land administration system	A lands ministry annual report or system statistics page giving titles issued, parcels registered or digital clearance turnaround times since 2023	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Company and business register	A registration agency annual report or registry statistics release; the agency appears in the base only as a verification call from the land system in 2023	not yet probed
ZamConnect in operation	A service catalogue or project progress report naming agencies connected to it and the volume of exchanges it carries	not yet probed
Education management information system	A Ministry of Education statistical bulletin or system description; the base carries interactive boards and school connectivity but no named school information system	not yet probed
Central bank national payment system statistics	A national payment systems annual or quarterly report giving mobile money and switch transaction volumes and values; the base carries only inclusion rates quoted second-hand	not yet probed
Whether the seven pilot councils went live on the national portal by 2026-06-30	A local government ministry statement after 2026-06-30 listing councils live on the portal	not yet probed
Statistics agency release programme	Any statistics agency publication - census release, price index or national accounts bulletin, or its statistical release calendar; the wiki holds none, and every statistics figure comes from a compiler, the regulator, an agency or a survey vendor	not yet probed
Regulator annual or quarterly market performance report after 2022	A market performance report for 2023 or later; the only one held is the 2022 edition	not yet probed
A national earth-observation or satellite-data programme	A Zambian space or earth-observation policy, a national satellite data agreement, or the spatial data portal's dataset inventory naming its imagery sources	not yet probed
Data Protection Act statutory instruments and regulations	The Government Gazette carrying the Act's commencement order and any statutory instruments made under it on registration of controllers, transfer rules and breach notification	not yet probed
Data protection regulator enforcement record	The Office's annual report or a published register of controllers, complaints, breach notifications and enforcement decisions	not yet probed
Cabinet decision to repeal and replace the Data Protection Act 2021	The Cabinet decision or the gazetted amendment or repeal Bill; the base carries only a civil-society report's statement of intent, current to late 2025	not yet probed
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, statutory text	The gazetted text of the Act, which would establish whether the interception mandate and central monitoring centre attributed to it are provisions of the Act	not yet probed
Enforcement outturn under the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025	Charge, prosecution or conviction figures from the National Prosecution Authority or the Judiciary, or a ministerial statement to the National Assembly giving counts since 2026-07-18	not yet probed
Access to information law	A gazetted Access to Information Act or Bill; no held source states whether Zambia has one, and the base carries no position at any date	not yet probed
National data-sharing, interoperability or data-classification standard	A state ICT institute published interoperability framework or government data standard; the base holds only a 2014 health-sector standard	not yet probed
Ratification of the AU Malabo Convention	The African Union list of signatures, ratifications and accessions, or a Zambian instrument of ratification	not yet probed
National AI Strategy text	The published strategy document or a Cabinet approval record; a continental review treats a Zambian strategy as extant while the government calls it forthcoming	not yet probed
Parliamentary and public contestation of Zambia's data governance	Hansard for the sittings at which the cyber Acts and the data protection Act were debated; the base holds two sources on this subject and one is a paywalled lede	not yet probed
National open data portal and open data policy	A government open-data portal with a dataset inventory and licence terms, or a Cabinet-approved open data policy; the base holds only the geospatial portal	not yet probed
EU-Zambia digital cooperation	A European Commission or EU Delegation announcement, Global Gateway project fiche or financing agreement naming a Zambian digital investment; the base holds zero Zambia sources on this subject	not yet probed
Legal basis for personal-data transfers between Zambia and the EU	A European Commission adequacy decision, or a Zambian data protection determination or guidance on cross-border transfer mechanisms	not yet probed
Any Gulf-state technology engagement with Zambia	A bilateral agreement, investment record or ministerial visit involving the UAE, Saudi Arabia or Qatar; nothing on file, the base holding zero Zambia sources on this subject	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Artificial intelligence budget line or implementation costing	The 2026 or 2027 national budget estimates showing an AI allocation, or a costed implementation plan annexed to the strategy	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence institution or agency	A statutory instrument or cabinet decision establishing a Zambian AI body; nothing names one, and the only institution on offer is the proposed international lab	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence compute inventory	A state ICT institute or ministry statement of installed government compute, or the technical annex to the vendor memorandum	not yet probed
Government innovation or venture fund	A budget line, fund charter or disbursement record; the base holds no Zambian public innovation fund of any kind	not yet probed
Technology hub inventory	A directory or count of Zambian innovation hubs; one hub is named anywhere in the base, and long-standing hubs appear nowhere in it	not yet probed
Zambian startup funding totals	The underlying diversity report, or an African startup funding report with a Zambia line; only continental aggregates are held	not yet probed
ICT sector contribution to GDP	A statistics agency national-accounts release with an ICT sector share; the Presidential Delivery Unit called ICT one of Zambia's fastest-growing sectors with no figure behind it	not yet probed
Ministry of Technology and Science annual appropriation	Zambia's Estimates of Revenue and Expenditure for FY2025 and FY2026, head-level lines for the technology ministry and the state ICT institute; there is no domestic budget archive for Zambia	not yet probed
Universal Access and Service Fund accounts	The regulator's annual report or the fund's own audited financial statements, giving the levy rate, fund balance and annual disbursement	not yet probed
State ICT institute appropriation and project counterpart funding	The acceleration project financing agreement or the estimates line showing the government's counterpart contribution against the US\$100 million grant	not yet probed
National digital literacy rate or programme	A regulator or statistics agency ICT household survey reporting digital skills prevalence, or a named national digital-literacy curriculum document	not yet probed
University or national ICT research institute	A named research centre's establishment instrument, funding line or publication record; no Zambian research institution appears in any held source	not yet probed
Digital skills targets under the e-Government Plan 2023-2026	The plan itself, which the hub names but no held source reproduces or quantifies	not yet probed
Gender gap in internet use or mobile ownership	An industry association gender-gap country figure or a regulator or statistics agency survey disaggregating internet use by sex	not yet probed
Rural-urban internet use split	A regulator market report or household survey disaggregating internet use by residence; the base gives only that 52.4% of the population is rural	not yet probed
Device affordability and data cost as a share of income	An affordability alliance or ITU affordability figure for Zambia; the base holds only the appraisal statement that fixed broadband exceeds 12% of gross national income per head	not yet probed
Digital access for persons with disabilities	A national disability-inclusion policy or regulator programme document; the base holds only individual ICT donations to two special schools	not yet probed

The regulator's own record is the largest single absence. The most recent annual market performance report the wiki holds is for 2022, so no current subscriber, penetration, coverage, pricing or market-revenue figure exists, and every government coverage claim of 80%, 92% or 94% is therefore untestable ([compiler analysis](#)).

Three further silences bear directly on the report's own claims. No statistics agency publication of any kind is held. No central bank payment system statistics are held, so the national switch's transaction volumes cannot be stated. And the outcome of the three-month campaign launched in April 2025 to issue 3.5 million identity documents was never published.

The two cyber statutes are both held as gazetted (Act No. 3 acquired 2026-08-09); what is not held is any enforcement outturn, statutory instrument or court record made under either.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-11
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/reports/ZMB/
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.